Photographic Technology

Louisville, Kentucky

2023 TSA National Conference

Participant ID: [redacted]

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Overall Information

Theme and subjects

The annual theme for this year's photography challenge was based on the elements of nature. As per usual, such as with last year's theme of "challenges", this task is incredibly broad with plenty of room for creativity. So, I decided to further refine the challenge and search for ways to capture how we as people harness and use the elements of nature.

I selected my subjects to show how water, fire, air, and the earth play important roles in everyday life and how we manipulate them to maintain safety and comfort on Earth. I faced few challenges in selecting these subjects because I based my interpretation of the theme on common aspects of life.

Photographic challenges

I struggled to take a few of my photos because they relied on wind or flames to fill the frame just right. It was also difficult to select the right image out of those I took of each subject, because I wanted to pick an angle that made the best connection with the viewer.

In addition, it was challenging to frame each shot to keep shadows right where I wanted them. I like vivid colors in much of my work, and dark shadows can throw that feeling off quickly.

Final selection and editing

To select my final five images, I started by removing any obvious poor candidates, such as blurred or test shots. I further narrowed my choices by searching for angles that told a story — photos that make the viewer feel as if they're right on the scene.

After hand-picking my final images, I edited them with Adobe Lightroom, generally adjusting the crop, lighting, and colors of each photo.

Of course, technology never comes without its fair share of glitches, but I was mostly able to edit my photos as I imagined them.

Color Image Description

Technical information

This photo was taken on a Canon EOS Rebel T2i. It was taken with an f-stop of 11, an exposure time of 1/125 second, an ISO speed of 100, and a focal length of 21 millimeters.

Theme application

This image of a fire captain practicing the use of a fire hose fits with this year's photography theme because it demonstrates how one element, water, plays a crucial role in protecting our society from another, fire. Without knowing how to utilize water in this way, fires would take many more lives and require far greater effort to fight. We have thankfully learned how to use water to our advantage as a society to protect ourselves.

Editing process

To edit this photo, I took the following steps:

- Increased the vibrance and saturation
- Individually adjusted the saturation of some color groups
- Added a black vignette

Color Image

Black and White Image Description

Technical information

This photo was taken on a Canon EOS Rebel T2i. It was taken with an f-stop of 4.0, an exposure time of 1/1000 second, an ISO speed of 100, and a focal length of 27 millimeters.

Theme application

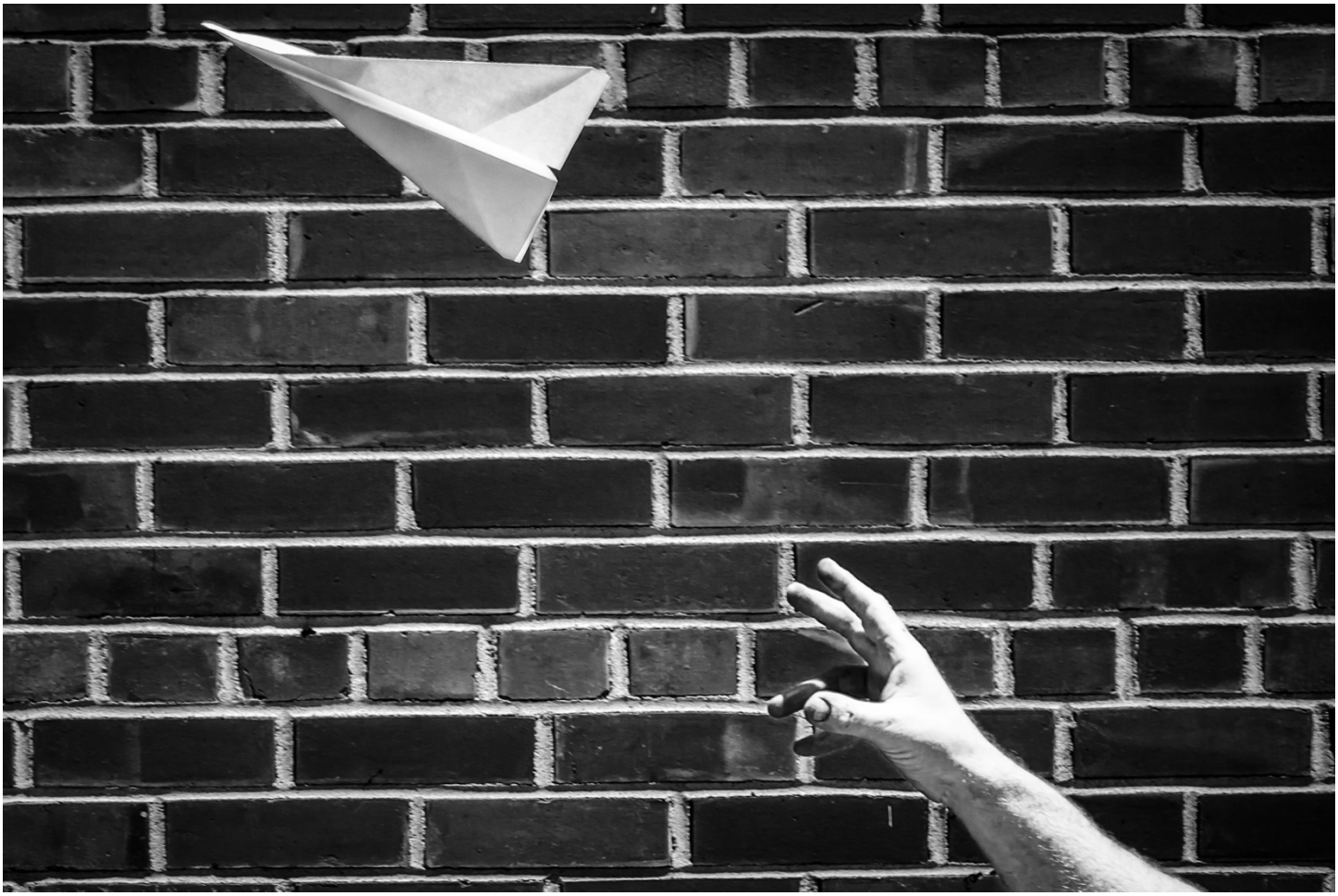
This photo of a man gently tossing a paper airplane shows how we can use nature's elements for fun and enjoyment. The air swiftly and silently carries away the simple man-made creation while having no effect on the sturdy brick wall behind it.

Editing process

To edit this photo, I took the following steps:

- Cropped the image
- Adjusted horizontal and vertical distortion to straighten the brick lines
- Changed the color to black and white
- Darkened the reds and lightened the yellows
- Selectively brightened the plane and arm, and darkened the brick wall to improve contrast
- Added a black vignette

Black and White Image



Macro Image Description

Technical information

This photo was taken on a Canon EOS Rebel T2i. It was taken with an f-stop of 4.5, an exposure time of 1/640 second, an ISO speed of 100, and a focal length of 33 millimeters.

Theme application

This photo relates to the theme of elements because it shows a plant preparing to bloom out of the earth in a new spring season. It demonstrates our planet's way of creating new life for all to enjoy. People cultivate many types of plants to provide food and decoration for our society, manipulating the earth as we see fit while nature still runs its course.

Editing process

To edit this photo, I took the following steps:

- Cropped the image
- Adjusted the hue, saturation, and luminance values for the orange, yellow, and green color groups
- Added a black vignette

Macro Image

Still Life Image Description

Technical information

This photo was taken on a Canon EOS Rebel T2i. It was taken with an f-stop of 8.0, an exposure time of 1/200 second, an ISO speed of 100, and a focal length of 55 millimeters.

Theme application

This image fits in with the photography challenge because it shows a gentle breeze waving a flag to honor a fallen U.S. Army soldier's grave. Humans may have set up the flag in front of the grave in the first place, but nature's elements are what truly honor those who served our country in this shot.

Editing process

To edit this photo, I took the following steps:

- Cropped and straightened the image
- Adjusted the hue and saturation values for the red, orange, blue, and purple color groups
- Added a black vignette

Still Life Image

Student Choice Image Description

Technical information

This photo was taken on a Canon EOS Rebel T2i. It was taken with an f-stop of 4.5, an exposure time of 1/10 second, an ISO speed of 1600, and a focal length of 55 millimeters.

Theme application

This final image fits with the theme of nature's elements by showing how people use fire for fun, preparing a deliciously toasted marshmallow. By building the fire, starting it, maintaining it, and using it to cook, people harness the immense powers of one of nature's core elements.

Editing process

To edit this photo, I took the following steps:

- Adjusted the white balance to increase warm tones
- Individually adjusted the hue, saturation, and luminance values for most color groups
- Added a black vignette

Student Choice Image

Resources

I used a Canon EOS Rebel T2i camera to take these photos.

I culled some of my photos using Narrative Select Pro. To edit my photos, I used Adobe Photoshop Lightroom on an Apple MacBook Pro laptop computer.

To edit this portfolio, I used Microsoft Word. I converted it to a PDF document and combined it with other attached pages using Adobe Acrobat to generate my final portfolio file.

Documents

Following this page are these attached documents:

1. Student Copyright Checklist
2. Photo Consent and Release (from the fire captain in the Color Image)
3. Photo Consent and Release (from the man in the Black and White Image)

STUDENT COPYRIGHT CHECKLIST *(for students to complete and advisors to verify)*

STUDENT: Answer question 1 below.

1) Does your solution to the competitive event integrate any type of music and/or sound? ☐ YES ☑ NO
   If NO, go to question 2.
   If YES, is the music and/or sound copyrighted? ☐ YES ☐ NO
   If YES, move to question 1A. If NO, move to question 1B.
   1A) Have you asked for author permission to use the music and/or sound in your solution and included that permission (letter/form) in your documentation? If YES, move to question 2. If NO, ask for permission and if permission is granted, include the permission in your documentation.
   1B) Is the music/sound royalty free, or did you create the music/sound yourself? If YES, cite the royalty free music/sound OR your original music/sound properly in your documentation.

CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below regarding your student's answer(s) to the use of music/sound in his/her competitive event solution. Even if your student answers "NO" to question 1, please sign below noting that you have evaluated the competitive event solution and the student answered the question(s) accurately.

I, [redacted] (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that any use of music/sound is done so with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation and/or the solution has been found to have no music/sound included.

STUDENT: Answer question 2 below.

2) Does your solution to the competitive event integrate any graphics/videos? ☑ YES ☐ NO
   If NO, go to question 3.
   If YES, is(are) the graphics/videos copyrighted, registered and/or trademarked? ☐ YES ☑ NO
   If YES, move to question 2A. If NO, move to question 2B.
   2A) Have you asked for author permission to use the graphics and/or videos in your solution and included a permission (letter/form) in your documentation for graphic/video used? If YES, move to question 3. If NO, ask for permission and if permission is granted, include the permission in your documentation.
   2B) Is(are) the graphics/videos royalty free, or did you create your own graphic? If YES, cite the royalty free graphics/videos OR your own original graphics/videos properly in your documentation.

CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below regarding your student's answer(s) to the use of graphics/videos in his/her competitive event solution. Even if your student answers "NO" to question 2, please sign below noting that you have evaluated the competitive event solution and the student answered the question(s) accurately.

I, [redacted] (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that the use of graphics/videos with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation and/or the solution has been found to have no graphics/videos included.

STUDENT: Answer question 3 below.

3) Does your solution to the competitive event use another's thoughts or research? ☐ YES ☑ NO
   If NO, this is the end of the checklist.
   If YES, have you properly cited other's thoughts or research in your documentation? ☐ YES ☐ NO
   CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below regarding your student's answer(s) to having integrated any thoughts/research of others in his/her competitive event solution. Even if your student answers "NO" to question 3, please sign below noting that you have evaluated the competitive event solution and the student answered the question(s) accurately.
   I, [redacted] (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that the use of the thoughts/research of others is done so with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation and/or the solution has been found to have all original thought with no use of other's thoughts/research.

Student Name: Participant [redacted]

Chapter Advisor Signature: [redacted]

PHOTO/FILM/VIDEO CONSENT AND RELEASE

I hereby give permission for images of my child or myself (as applicable), captured during Technology Student Association (TSA) activities through film, photo or digital camera, to be used solely for the purposes of TSA promotional materials and publications, and I waive any rights of compensation or ownership thereto.

N/A

Name of Minor in Images (please print)

N/A

Name of Minor's Parent/Guardian (please print)

[redacted]

Name of Adult in Images (please print)

[redacted]

Parent/Guardian or Adult's Signature (as applicable)

[redacted]

Date

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Name of Adult in Images (please print)

[redacted]

Parent/Guardian or Adult's Signature (as applicable)

[redacted]

Date